

Lesson 23: Public speaking

HS192 Introduction to Writing - 2
@ IITGN, 2025-26



Today's learning objective

**Deliver a speech using effective
public speaking techniques**

What Makes a Speech Effective?

Today you will practice your speeches.

In preparation, we will watch several video examples of famous speeches in history.



Rhetorical situation 1: Barack Obama

Author: Barack Obama

Purpose: To celebrate winning the Presidency

Audience: a large group of voters who campaigned for him and were very excited by his victory

Message: Hope and optimism for the United States' future.

Context: Obama was the first Black president in American history (2008), in a country that had a long history of racial struggles, oppression, and conflict.

Let's watch the video

And analyze what made the delivery
of Obama's speech effective:

body language?

pacing, his volume?

the emotion?

tone of his voice?

or, something else?



What made the *delivery* of his speech effective?



An effective speaker

Appears confident.

Speaks loudly enough to be heard (but does not shout).

Makes eye contact.

Responds to and connects with their audience.

Matches their emotion and tone to the content of their speech.

Does not speak too quickly, and pauses for emphasis in important moments.

Avoids filler words like “um,” and “ok”.

Stands straight up, with shoulders back, and gestures when appropriate and natural.



Rhetorical situation 2: Malala

Author: Malala Yousafzai

Purpose: To bring attention to her personal story and her larger cause

Audience: The UN youth delegation

Message: The importance of women's rights and education for women

Context: She has won the Nobel Peace Prize, and is a known public figure because of what the Taliban did to her.



Group Activity 1: Instructions

**** FOR USE BY INSTRUCTOR ONLY ****

Number of participants: 2 students

Put partners together

Length of activity: 10 minutes

Instructor and TAs move around the classroom, pop in and out of different groups.

Resource: Malala's speech

<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=3rNhZu3ttIU&feature=youtu.be>

Pair activity

- Discuss what you noticed about Malala's tone, pacing, body language, and eye contact. If needed, watch again 3:48-7:45.
- Find at least **two** moments in the speech that was particularly effective in **more than one** category (body language, tone, etc).
- Explain the line(s) that you thought were effective, and then share your reasoning. Be prepared to share with the class.



Debrief

What made Malala's speech effective overall?

Share one moment in the speech that was particularly effective.

Explain the line(s) that you found effective, and then share your reasoning.

How to prepare for an effective speech

- ❑ Prepare **notecards**. (Don't read word-for-word!)
- ❑ Practice, **practice**, practice.
- ❑ **Dress** in a way that makes you feel confident.
- ❑ Get rid of gum, food, jewelry, or anything that will **distract** your audience.
- ❑ Be aware of **physical tics** that may make you appear nervous.
- ❑ Make sure your **physical environment** is in order before you begin.



Points to consider

- ❑ **Tone:** Does the emotion and tone in the speaker's voice match the message? Are there any points in the speech where the tone should be adjusted?
- ❑ **Body language:** Does the speaker stand up straight and have proper body language? Does the speaker gesture or interact with the audience as appropriate? Does the speaker engage in any distracting body language, such as fidgeting?
- ❑ **Eye Contact:** Does the speaker make eye contact with his/her audience as much as possible? Does he look across the audience, and not just at one point?
- ❑ **Pacing:** Does the speaker have the appropriate pacing (not too fast, and not too slow)? Does the speaker pause for emphasis at important parts of his/her speech? **Volume:** Is the speech loud enough for everyone to hear?
- ❑ **Volume:** Is the speech loud enough for everyone to hear?

Pair activity

Share your plan of presentation with the group members.

Create a script for presentation that fits your slides or other visual components.

Consider tone, body language, eye contact, pacing and volume.

Also arrange ways to draw audience's attention and align with their emotions.

Homework

Practice your speech before your presentation, using the feedback from your classmates today.

Be ready to persuade your audience!

Submit your slides in the Google slides format at least 4 hours before the class begins.

